

Russell Dudek

DIRECTOR OF OPERATIONS | AI-ENABLED EXECUTION | DATA & PRODUCT OPERATIONS

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<https://russelldudek.github.io/Foundation/>

Operator-technologist who turns executive intent into visible, owned, measurable work. Builds the mechanisms between strategy and execution: portfolio prioritization, decision rights, cross-functional cadence, AI-enabled workflow design, dashboards, escalation, standard work, and evidence that changes resource allocation.

ROLE-ALIGNED CAPABILITIES

Executive extension and strategic roadmaps

Data, analytics, product, and marketing alignment

Revenue and margin prioritization

AI-enabled capacity release

KPI, dashboard, and blocker visibility

Forecast and planning cadence

Technical-team translation

Remote cross-functional execution

OPERATING THESIS

Every strategic initiative should expose the customer decision it improves, its economic logic, one accountable owner, dependencies, capacity load, trust conditions, and the evidence that determines whether to accelerate, sequence, repair, or stop.

CREDENTIALS

- Google AI Essentials
- Food Safety Management Certification
- IBM Enterprise Design Thinking Practitioner
- Six Sigma Certification
- OSHA 10

SELECTED EXPERIENCE

Vape-Jet

2025-Present

Director of Operations

- Leads AI-first operating transformation across production, purchasing, quality, customer success, support, engineering issue flow, ERP/Odoo, Jira, HubSpot, Slack, telemetry, and AI-assisted workflows.
- Connects factory, field, customer, and machine-fleet signals into prioritized work, earlier risk detection, cleaner handoffs, dashboards, standard work, training, and accountability.
- Works in a software-enabled robotics and machine-vision environment with approximately 1,000 fielded robots informing support and operating feedback loops.
- Builds lightweight systems that expose recurring quality, machine, customer, and process issues before they become executive surprises.

Amazon

2014-2018

Operations Management / Site Leader

- Led launch and execution for Amazon Prime Pittsburgh in a 24/7 customer-backward environment supporting approximately five million second-day orders annually.
- Built leadership routines, labor planning, throughput visibility, escalation paths, standard work, and operating mechanisms across safety, quality, customer experience, and team engagement.
- Served on the Amazon Prime Now launch team with Whole Foods and applied Lean and Gemba methods to frontline execution.
- Contributed to logistics innovation through Prime Air research and Amazon Flex geolocation concepts.

Compunetics

2000-2013

Director of Operations and Engineering Management

- Progressed through R&D program management, production management, strategic acquisition, operations management, and director-level leadership.
- Led engineering, manufacturing, quality, customer delivery, and complex technical programs in advanced electronics and high-reliability environments.
- Built quality systems, standard work, root-cause practices, performance measures, and process controls.
- Collaborated with high-consequence customers and partners including DoD, CERN, Intel, and AMD.

DudeWorth

2017-Present

Founder / AI and Automation Advisor

- Develops AI-readiness and opportunity frameworks that assess value, feasibility, data readiness, governance, adoption burden, reuse, and time-to-value.
- Designs agentic workflow patterns using structured context, retrieval, AI agents, human judgment, escalation, decision records, evaluation, and governance rails.
- Advises on AI-enabled operations, logistics technology, warehouse automation, AMRs, ASRS, cobots, transportation systems, network analysis, and workflow design.

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TECHNICAL TOOLKIT

- Agentic AI and LLM workflows
- RAG patterns and human-in-the-loop design
- Python, SQL, JavaScript, TensorFlow
- Tableau
- ERP/Odoo workflows
- Jira, Confluence, HubSpot, Slack
- GIS and mapping workflows

EDUCATION

University of Pittsburgh
Bachelor of Science

Academic grounding includes materials science, physical chemistry, and biology-related studies.

Google Scholar profile

LEADERSHIP THROUGH-LINE

Demonstrates leadership through decision systems, operating cadence, coaching, accountability, technical translation, and hands-on problem solving.

FOUNDATION DATA FIT

- Executive extension without PMO drag
- Data-rich technical operations
- AI tied to work and economics
- Remote and distributed execution
- Revenue-prioritized capacity

COMPLEMENTARY EXPERIENCE

Cardinal Building Products

2021-2023

Regional Director

- Built the company's first remote regional operation.
- Modernized distributed customer, CRM, commercial, fulfillment, logistics, digital marketing, SEO, and online-buying workflows.
- Advanced AI-enhanced transportation-management and route-planning concepts.

ZeusVu

2018-2022

Chief Pilot, Autonomous Systems and Aerial Data Operations

- Led regulated drone operations across medical, energy, logistics, real-estate, and restricted-airspace contexts with a 100% safety record and no FAA incidents.
- Developed TensorFlow-based concepts for automated aerial inventory and computer-vision-enabled field intelligence.
- Designed medical drone delivery and chain-of-custody concepts connecting technology, risk, stakeholders, and governed execution.

Enviro Social Capital

2014-2017

Chairman of the Board

- Co-founded and led a public-private impact initiative focused on sustainable infrastructure, green finance, and civic transformation.
- Helped shape and evaluate a \$200 million Social Impact Bond feasibility concept for Pittsburgh sewage and green-infrastructure improvement.

IEEE

2012-2016

CMPT and EDS Pittsburgh Chapter Chair

- Led regional technology programming connecting industry, academia, STEM outreach, electronics, manufacturing, and emerging technology.
- Organized conferences, seminars, business tours, and technical programming.

HOW THE EVIDENCE MAPS TO THE WORK

Strategic alignment

Translates priorities into operating mechanisms, ownership, escalation, and visible follow-through.

Technical execution

Works across engineering, quality, data-rich systems, robotics, customer delivery, and operational constraints.

AI efficiency

Frames AI around workflow context, human authority, evaluation, adoption, governance, and capacity released.

Scalability

Builds standard work, dashboards, planning cadence, remote operations, and exception-based review without unnecessary overhead.

Revenue prioritization

Connects customer commitments, delivery burden, throughput, quality, and operating evidence to resource decisions.

Executive communication

Makes complex technical and operating work legible to leaders, teams, partners, and high-consequence stakeholders.